



Two possible portraits of a powerful and pious Chola queen. (Above, left) A Chola ‘bronze’ now identified as the tenth-century Chola queen Sembiyan Mayadevi, a statuette which probably came from her temple of Kailasanatha Svamin in the village named after her. (Above, right) One of the near life-size female figures set in niches in the walls of the Nageshwaram temple at Kumbakonam, dedicated to Shiva in the form of Nageshwara, the serpent-king.